

# Sentence Completion

## COMPLETE LEARNING GUIDE

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### What You'll Learn

Sentence completion questions differ from single-word fill-in-the-blank questions in that the missing piece is often an entire clause or phrase, and the task is to judge which candidate completion is the most LOGICALLY consistent continuation of the sentence's stated premise — not merely which one is grammatically valid or generally plausible. A frequent trap is a completion option that is true in general or well-written in isolation but doesn't actually follow from what the sentence itself already states. This sub-module covers distinguishing clause-level completion from word-level fill-in-the-blank, cause-effect completions, contrast completions, conditional ('if...then') completions, eliminating true-but-off-topic completions, eliminating completions that contradict the sentence's own stated fact, and matching tone/register between the completion and the rest of the sentence.

### 1. Clause-Level Completion vs Word-Level Blanks

Sentence completion asks you to finish an entire thought with a full clause, which means you must track the sentence's internal logic (cause, contrast, condition) across its full length, not just check whether one word fits grammatically into a slot.

- 'The company had record profits this quarter, yet \_\_\_\_\_. ' The completion must logically continue the 'yet' (contrast) with something surprising given record profits — e.g., '...it still announced layoffs the following week' — not simply any grammatically valid clause.

### 2. Cause-Effect Completions

When a sentence sets up a cause, the completion should describe a plausible, logically connected effect — not an unrelated fact that happens to be true.

- 'Because the bridge had been closed for repairs for three months, \_\_\_\_\_. ' Correct completion: '...commuters were forced to take a much longer route to work.' A distractor like '...the bridge was built fifty years ago' is true-sounding background information but is not a consequence of the closure.

### 3. Contrast Completions

Signal words like 'although', 'but', 'yet', and 'despite' require a completion that reverses the expectation set up by the first half of the sentence — the correct completion must genuinely surprise given what came before it.

- 'Although the new employee had no prior experience, \_\_\_\_\_. ' Correct: '...she quickly became the top performer on the team.' A wrong completion like '...she struggled with the tasks' fails because it does NOT contrast with 'no prior experience' — it's exactly what you'd expect, defeating the purpose of 'although'.

## 4. Conditional (If...Then) Completions

A conditional sentence's completion must follow the specific logical structure set up by 'if' — real-world plausibility isn't enough; the completion must be the direct logical consequence of the stated condition.

- 'If the company fails to meet the new safety regulations by December, \_\_\_\_\_. ' Correct: '...it will be barred from operating in the state.' A distractor like '...its employees will receive a bonus' is unrelated to the stated conditional consequence, even if it's a plausible-sounding business fact on its own.

## 5. Eliminating True-but-Off-Topic Completions

A completion can be factually reasonable and grammatically perfect while still being wrong because it doesn't address what the specific sentence is actually building toward — always ask 'does this follow FROM THIS sentence' rather than 'is this a true statement in general.'

- 'The factory's new machinery reduced production time by 40%, so \_\_\_\_\_. ' A true-but-off-topic completion: '...the factory was originally built in 1985.' Correct, on-topic completion: '...the company was able to fulfill orders much faster than before.'

## 6. Eliminating Completions That Contradict the Sentence's Own Stated Fact

Some wrong completions directly contradict a fact already given earlier in the same sentence — this is a fast, mechanical way to eliminate an option without needing deep interpretation.

- 'Despite receiving glowing reviews from critics, the film \_\_\_\_\_. ' A completion like '...went on to win the top award, as expected' contradicts the 'despite' setup (which promises a surprising outcome) — the logically consistent completion is something like '...performed poorly at the box office.'

## 7. Matching Tone and Register

The completion's vocabulary and formality level should match the rest of the sentence — a formal, technical sentence should not be completed with a casual or colloquial clause, even if that clause is logically consistent.

- 'The quarterly audit revealed significant discrepancies in the reported figures, prompting \_\_\_\_\_. ' A tonally mismatched completion: '...everyone to freak out about it.' A tonally consistent completion: '...an immediate internal investigation by the finance team.'

## Common Pitfalls

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- Choosing a completion that is grammatically fine and generally plausible but doesn't logically follow from what the sentence itself states.
- Missing that a contrast word ('although', 'yet', 'despite') requires the completion to be genuinely surprising given the sentence's first half.
- Selecting a completion that's true as a general fact but off-topic relative to what the sentence is specifically building toward.
- Overlooking a direct contradiction between the completion and a fact already stated earlier in the same sentence.
- Picking a completion whose tone or formality clashes with the rest of the sentence.
- Treating a conditional ('if...then') sentence's completion as any plausible outcome instead of the specific logical consequence of the stated condition.

## Key Takeaways

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- Judge completions by whether they logically follow from THIS sentence, not by whether they're true or plausible in general.
- Contrast words ('although', 'yet', 'despite') demand a completion that genuinely reverses the expectation set up earlier in the sentence.
- Cause-effect and conditional sentences need a completion that is the direct, specific consequence of the stated cause or condition.
- Eliminate completions that quietly contradict a fact already given earlier in the same sentence.
- Match the completion's tone and formality to the rest of the sentence.
- Re-read the full sentence with your chosen completion inserted to do a final logic check before finalizing.

## Learn More

**IndiaBix — Verbal Ability: Sentence Completion**

<https://www.indiabix.com/verbal-ability/completion-of-blanks/>

**GeeksforGeeks — Sentence Completion Questions**

<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/verbal-ability-questions-and-answers/>